

» CHEQUERED FLAG



A LEGEND REBORN

Lewis Hamilton's first win in Ferrari colours sparked emotional scenes in Barcelona as the seven-time champion returned to the top step of the podium.

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Picture this: a 41-year-old veteran, seven-time World Champion and winner of 105 previous races jumping up and down in celebration after throwing himself onto his mechanics stationed near parc ferme. The top step on the podium is something he has seen regularly in his 19-year career. Yet there was a fresh, childlike delight about Lewis Hamilton when he romped home to victory at the Barcelona Grand Prix.

Obviously, emotions will run high when you snap a 686-day wait for a race win. But this was something more. Even the most successful F1 driver in history needed to get down on his haunches to catch his breath amid the overwhelming emotion. And as Ferrari's passionate garage belted out the Italian national anthem during the podium celebrations, a stray tear trickled down the cheek of the legend.

"I watched Ferrari have all that success when I was younger, watching it on TV. And as I've been racing here, I'd always watch the screens and wonder what it'd be like to win in that car and it's

come," Hamilton said after the race win. "I started out [with] a dream last year, which seemed almost impossible during my time last year, but we never gave up hope and the team just continued to lift me up. We made so many changes and we made so many improvements. And on top of that, I have the greatest fan base a sportsman could ever ask for," he added.

Truth be told, this win had been coming. Back-to-back second-place finishes in Canada and Monaco had propelled the Briton to second place in the drivers' standings behind runaway leader Kimi Antonelli. After a difficult first season at the Scuderia, where he struggled to adapt to the ground-effect cars, the 2026 regulations appear to have